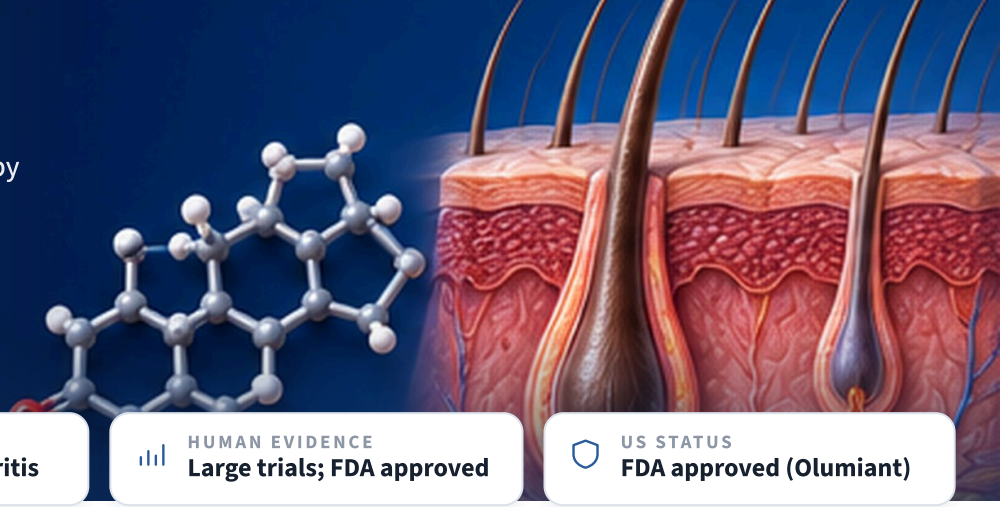
HAIR LOSS 09

Baricitinib

Janus kinase (JAK1 and JAK2) inhibitor taken by mouth, a small-molecule immune drug



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
JAK inhibitor	Alopecia areata, arthritis	Large trials; FDA approved	FDA approved (Olumiant)

STUDIED FOR

Alopecia areata	Rheumatoid arthritis	COVID-19
HUMAN	HUMAN	HUMAN

Not for pattern hair loss. Alopecia areata is an autoimmune disease. Baricitinib is not approved for male pattern hair loss.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Baricitinib ▶ JAK1 and JAK2 ▶ STAT signaling ▶ Immune attack

- **JAK enzymes** pass on signals from cytokine and growth-factor receptors
- **Blocks JAKs,** preventing activation of STATs, which modulate gene expression
- **Cytokines** blocked are thought to drive the immune attack on hair follicles

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- 2 Phase 3 trials, 1,200 adults
- 1 trial of 257 people aged 12+
- SALT 20 or less at week 36: 35.9–38.8% (4 mg)

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Use in pattern hair loss
- Use under age 12

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
About 12 to 16 hours	By mouth (tablets)
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Peak in about 1 hour; mostly kidney clearance; CYP3A4 minor	Prescription tablets (Olumiant)
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Lymphocytes, neutrophils, hemoglobin, liver enzymes, lipids	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved: severe alopecia areata, age 12+ (2026)
FDA	Boxed warning: infections, cancer, heart, clots
EMA	Authorised; includes severe alopecia areata
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Olumiant prescribing information (DailyMed), Oct 2026
2. King et al., N Engl J Med, BRAVE-AA1 and BRAVE-AA2, May 2022
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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